

## Handout 4.5: Greener Room Swap

Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Partner: \_\_\_\_\_

**Directions:** Part 1 and Part 2 fill in with the class. Part 3 is the swap: read the room, and for every item write a greener swap, the green factor it improves, and whether it is free, cheap (under \$25), or money. Then pick your top three.

### Word bank in other languages

| English       | Turkish           | Portuguese             | Spanish                 |
|---------------|-------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|
| reduce        | azaltmak          | reduzir                | reducir                 |
| reuse         | yeniden kullanmak | reutilizar             | reutilizar              |
| recycle       | geri dönüştürmek  | reciclar               | reciclar                |
| compost       | kompost           | compostagem (adubo)    | compost (abono)         |
| secondhand    | ikinci el         | de segunda mão (usado) | de segunda mano (usado) |
| natural light | doğal ışık        | luz natural            | luz natural             |
| waste         | atık              | lixo (resíduo)         | desecho (basura)        |

### Part 1: The four Rs and the five green factors

| The four Rs                    | What it means at home | One example          |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| Reduce                         |                       |                      |
| Reuse                          |                       |                      |
| Recycle                        |                       |                      |
| Compost ("rot")                |                       |                      |
| Green factor in a living space |                       | What makes it better |
| Natural light                  |                       |                      |
| Materials                      |                       |                      |
| Indoor air                     |                       |                      |
| Water                          |                       |                      |
| Waste                          |                       |                      |

## Part 2: Sort the twelve

Write each item in one bin. Some could go in two; pick the one that does the least harm.

Items: a glass jar, a cardboard box, a banana peel, a plastic bag, a T-shirt with a hole, a phone charger that works, a chipped mug, a stack of junk mail, a pizza box with grease, a wooden chair with a loose leg, a plastic water bottle, coffee grounds

| REDUCE (do not bring it in) | REUSE | RECYCLE | COMPOST |
|-----------------------------|-------|---------|---------|
|                             |       |         |         |
|                             |       |         |         |
|                             |       |         |         |
|                             |       |         |         |

## Part 3: The room

**A teen's bedroom.** The window has a broken blind that is stuck closed, so the lamp is on all day. The desk is particleboard and wobbles; the plan is to throw it out and buy another one like it for \$60. A can of aerosol air freshener sits on the dresser and gets sprayed every morning. Clothes and school things are stored in a set of six new plastic tubs bought last month. The bookshelf is a fast-furniture shelf that sagged in a year. A trash bag by the door holds clothes that do not fit anymore, headed for the curb. The radiator valve drips into a bucket that gets emptied every day. A fan runs all day, every day, with the door closed and the window shut.

| # | The item                                                  | Greener swap | Green factor<br>(light /<br>materials / air /<br>water / waste) | Free / cheap<br>(under \$25) /<br>money |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 1 | Broken blind,<br>lamp on all day                          |              |                                                                 |                                         |
| 2 | Wobbly<br>particleboard<br>desk, replace<br>with the same |              |                                                                 |                                         |
| 3 | Aerosol air<br>freshener every<br>morning                 |              |                                                                 |                                         |
| 4 | Six new plastic<br>tubs                                   |              |                                                                 |                                         |
| 5 | Sagging fast-                                             |              |                                                                 |                                         |

|   |                                             |  |  |  |
|---|---------------------------------------------|--|--|--|
|   | furniture<br>bookshelf                      |  |  |  |
| 6 | A bag of clothes<br>for the curb            |  |  |  |
| 7 | Radiator valve<br>dripping into a<br>bucket |  |  |  |
| 8 | Fan all day,<br>door and<br>window shut     |  |  |  |

**Top three** (most good for the least money), one sentence each on why:







**Grade 8 stretch:** Write two sentences to the landlord asking for the radiator valve to be fixed. Use the water and the money, not feelings.

